

KEY FIGURES:

+1,501 new arrivals

1,073,361

Refugees & Asylum seekers in Ethiopia
(as of September 2024)

+908 new arrivals

65,577

Refugees and asylum seekers fleeing conflict in Sudan to Ethiopia
(as of November 2024)

4.4M*

Internally displaced people in Ethiopia
(IOM/DTM February 2024)

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

As the year draws to a close, we would like to look back at the **milestones** achieved this year.

1. We supported the Government in the release of a new directive on the **Right to Work**, giving refugees access to employment.
2. Thanks to **resettlement** and **durable solutions opportunities**, 15,000 refugees set off to a new life.
3. **Digital IDs** were issued to refugees to facilitate their access to basic services and improve their inclusivity
4. The **Makatet** roadmap to foster the social and economic inclusion of refugees is underway.
5. With UN and Government counterparts we launched the **Pathway to Solutions to Internal Displacement**, allowing Ethiopian families displaced to rebuild their lives after years of uncertainty.
6. In **Somali** region, **land ownership titles** and houses built by the regional authorities were handed to **IDPs**.
7. In **Amhara** and Benishangul Gumuz, we relocated thousands of refugees fleeing conflict in **Sudan** to safer settlements.
8. In **Gambella**, **Tigray** and **Afar**, agricultural **cooperatives**, **development prospects** and **livelihood opportunities** are on the rise.

Refugees want to be **self-reliant** and want to give back to the **communities** hosting them.

Our teams will continue working tirelessly to offer our support to all regions and provide refugees with **safe spaces** and **opportunities** to thrive.

We would like to thank the **Ethiopian Government** for the support and remarkable hospitality in hosting over 1 million refugees, and our **donors** and **partners** for their commitment and good work throughout the year.

SECTORAL HIGHLIGHTS:



Protection

+1,444
refugees

Have been issued with Residence Permits



Water & Sanitation

Refugees get

14L
per person per day

vs minimum standard of

20L



Livelihoods

12
refugee

Women in the Afar region have successfully diversified their income sources.



Resettlement

+5,748
refugees

have departed from Ethiopia on private sponsorship and resettlement.



RESETTLEMENT – HUMAN STORY

🌟 15 years in a refugee camp in ET caring for his wheelchair-bound son never discouraged Ahmed from keeping hopes high.

They were both resettled to the US where Ahmed wants to learn English & contribute to the society that is so generously hosting them. [Read more.](#)

POPULATION MOVEMENT FROM SUDAN

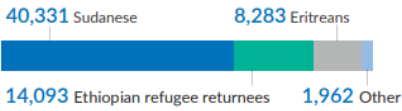
65,577

24,417

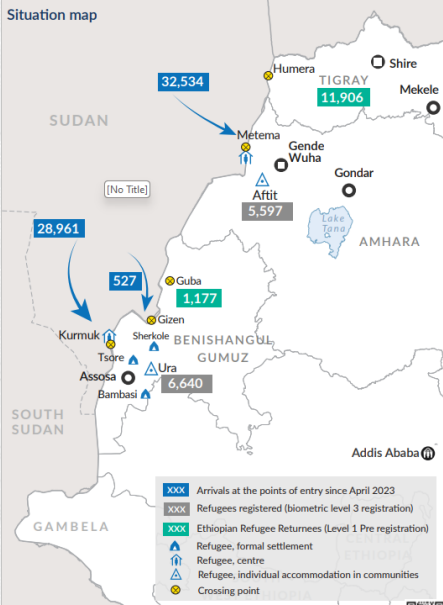
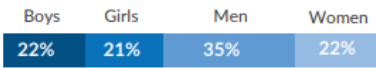
Total arrivals in need of international protection since April 2023

Total arrivals in 2024

Nationality breakdown



Gender breakdown



Protection

So far in 2024, over 24,417 new refugees and asylum seekers have arrived in Ethiopia, bringing the number of people in need of protection arriving from Sudan to 65,577 since April 2023. Along with partners, UNHCR is providing protection counselling, healthcare, and lifesaving humanitarian assistance to new arrivals in need of international protection. UNHCR continues to support and advocate with the Government of Ethiopia for full resumption of registration across the country.

Gender Based Violence

In November, all **gender-based violence survivors** were provided with comprehensive case management support. 328 refugees engaged in sessions on how to prevent GBV cases in refugee sites. 15 men and boys participated on session focusing on **prevention mechanisms for GBV**. 51 refugees have received **psychosocial support**. 579 women and girls have participated on **education sessions** within **Women and Girls Safe Spaces**. 17 refugee women at risk were briefed on available **legal assistance mechanisms** for GBV survivors. 175 refugees have also received GBV prevention information packs during **home-to-home visits**. Over 8,000 refugee women and girls were provided with **dignity kits**. 85 community mobilizers, religious leaders, local police forces, incentive workers and incentive workers were engaged in **GBV prevention and Community Based Complaint Mechanism** sessions. 230 out-of-school adolescents, women at risk, and GBV survivors were engaged in **business and life skills sessions**. Among them 20 were provided with **start-up capital** and they were supported to build cooperatives in Bokh.

Registration / Documentation

In November, UNHCR conducted a joint **detention monitoring** with RRS to help secure the **release of hundreds of urban refugees and asylum seekers** from detention. We provided USD 1.6 million **multipurpose cash assistance** to approximately 5,300 most vulnerable urban refugees to cover their basic needs. As of November 2024, 49 refugees have received their **work permits** and 1,444 have been issued with **residence permits**. **16 Days of activism against gender-based violence** was celebrated with different activities such as awareness sessions and panel discussions involving partners and the refugee community. World Child Day was celebrated in Addis Ababa on November 20th with the theme “Listen to the Future.” The event aimed to promote child protection, empower children, and enhance their participation in shaping their futures. .

Shelter & CRIs

In November, for refugees fleeing **Sudan**, UNHCR and its partner Action for the Needy in Ethiopia (ANE) set up **284 emergency shelters** and 125 **transitional shelters** In the Afit settlement (Amhara region), bringing the totals to **490 emergency shelters** and **135 transitional shelters**. Additionally, 6 **hangars** have been built, and continuous site development has resulted in 5.0 hectares of land being developed and a 2km access **road** being completed.

At the **Ura site** in the Benishangul-Gumuz region, 484 emergency shelters were completed, increasing the total to **1,753** providing shelter for thousands of Sudanese refugees.

In **Gambella**, 90 **transitional shelters** have been completed and occupied, with 150 more at various stages of completion in the Ngyennyiel and Pugnido refugee camps.

Despite these efforts, overall shelter coverage for refugees remains low at about 33%. Many refugees still live in old, dilapidated shelters or overcrowded emergency shelters, compromising their privacy, protection, and well-being. Additional funding is needed to construct more shelters to meet at least the minimum humanitarian standards.





POST OF THE MONTH



Aftit, Ethiopia

🏠 1st time in Aftit!

UNHCR ET Bernard Inkoom & team visited the #refugee site in #Amhara as security situation remains calm in the region.

They met with refugees to listen to their demands & visited schools, WASH & health facilities + ongoing roads & shelter construction works.



Water, Sanitation & Hygiene

In November, refugees in refugee camps and sites across the country had access to an average of **14 liters of water per person per day** (l/p/d), which is much lower than the required minimum standard of **20 l/p/d**. The household sanitation coverage in refugee camps as of June 2024 stands at 33 % which is significantly lower than the standard target of 85%. This indicates a substantial gap in meeting the necessary conditions for adequate sanitation, which is essential for preventing disease and ensuring the health and dignity of individuals in these settings.

In November, in Alemwach, Amhara region, 14 septic tanks and 11 emergency latrine blocks were completed. Innovative Humanitarian Services (IHS), with the Alemwach site refugee community and other stakeholders, colorfully commemorated **World Toilet Day 2024** on November 19, with the participation of RRS, UNHCR, and IHS representatives. World Toilet Day was also celebrated in Awbarre and Kebribeyah Refugee camps, Somali region, with the theme 'Toilets – A Place for Peace', highlighting how inadequate sanitation systems affect people's lives and show how sustainable sanitation is essential to a healthy and stable society. During the reporting period, 4,041 refugees in Dillo and Megado refugee settlements, were reached through hygiene and sanitation awareness raising and cleaning campaigns.

UNHCR, in collaboration with various partners, is committed to supporting the needs of refugees from Somalia and Sudan located in Ethiopia. Despite challenges, including power outages, fuel shortage, security issues, and logistical barriers, efforts are ongoing to provide essential resources such as water and sanitation facilities. The current **provision of water stands at 10 l/p/d**, which is below the emergency standard of 15 liters.

This decrease in water supply is concerning and highlights the need for improved infrastructure and resource management to meet the emergency thresholds. Additionally, the **latrine** ratio reported in July is **1:69**, significantly higher than the UNHCR minimum standard of **1:20** for shared emergency latrines. This discrepancy indicates a critical need for the **construction of additional sanitation facilities** to prevent the spread of diseases and ensure the dignity and safety of refugees.



Water, Sanitation & Hygiene (cont'd)

In November, the feasibility study for hydrogeological survey for borehole drilling has been completed in Ura, Benishangul-Gumuz region: 77 blocks of communal latrine with 4 stance each and twelve solid waste pits were completed. In Kurmuk, Benishangul-Gumuz region, six latrines' blocks were completed. In Bokh, Somali region, 3.5 km of piping (excavation and installation) and 20 water points was completed.

The primary reasons for the water shortages are: (i) insufficient funds to operate generators and other electromechanical equipment as required for the necessary pumping hours, (ii) limited availability of local water sources, (iii) aged electromechanical equipment: older equipment that requires continuous maintenance. For sanitation infrastructure, key gaps include (i) insufficient funds to construct additional latrines to meet the required standards, (ii) a volatile security situation in the Amhara region, and (iii) decreasing borehole capacities in the Somali region (Buramino and Helaweyn) are operating at low yield and frequently breaking down.

The **growing population of refugees** and host communities has surged demand, outstripping the limited water supply from existing schemes.



UNDERFUNDING in Water and Sanitation causes disease outbreaks, including cholera, and exposes women and girls to sexual violence as they walk long distances to fetch water and do not have adequate sanitation facilities. Read more [here](#).



Durable solutions

Livelihoods & Economic Integration

In the **Afar** region, twelve refugee women have successfully diversified their income sources. Initially engaged in individual income-generating activities like fruit and vegetable vending, these women have now **expanded their business** to traditional **crafts** and **retailing** clothes, showcasing their resilience and entrepreneurial spirit. In collaboration with our partner Wa-PYDO, we've facilitated an **annual financial audit** and performance inspection of **20 livestock and energy cooperatives** across five camps in the **Somali region**. Based on the findings and recommendations, the cooperatives were capacitated in the areas of good governance and business record keeping. The security situation in **Amhara** region remains a challenge for the implementation of livelihood projects within planned periods.

Resettlement

Over the past eleven months, the cases of **5,748 refugees** were submitted to various countries for resettlement consideration, surpassing the annual target of 4,000. In **November** alone, **1,218 refugees departed from Ethiopia**, including 475 for resettlement, 743 through private **sponsorships**, 28 were counseled on family **reunification**, and 75 on **scholarship** and job opportunities. Additionally, we assisted one individual in obtaining an **Emergency Travel document**.

LATEST UPDATES



RESETTLEMENT

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PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

This Protection Brief focuses on the situation of **refugees with disabilities** in Ethiopia. In alignment with the 2024 IDPD theme, "Amplifying the Leadership of Persons with Disabilities for an Inclusive and Sustainable Future," the brief specifically seeks to identify **persistent barriers** that **refugees with disabilities** face in accessing protection, **solutions, assistance**, and equitable access to **third-country solutions** in Ethiopia.

FUNDING UPDATE | 2024

\$426 million
Funding requirements for 2024

⚠️ **Only 43% of our funding requirements have been met so far this year** causing critical gaps in our response. UNHCR is grateful for the critical support provided by donors that have contributed to its work in Ethiopia, as well as to those who have contributed to UNHCR programmes globally with unearmarked or softly earmarked funds.

In 2023 - 2024, UNHCR is grateful for contributions by:



And Private Donors in Australia, China, Germany, Italy, Japan, the Netherlands, Republic of Korea, Spain, Sweden, UK, and USA

FOR MORE INFORMATION:



Together with the Government Refugees and Returnees Service (RRS), UNHCR, the UN Refugee Agency aims to protect, assist and provide durable solutions for refugees and asylum-seekers in Ethiopia. UNHCR works to strengthen refugee protection through the expansion of improved community-based and multi-sectoral child protection and programs addressing gender-based violence (GBV).

Visit UNHCR Ethiopia's Operational Data Portal for more information products [here](#).



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